

ASMIT DATTA

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September 2026

Graduate Research Assistant, general pool

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First, I would like to talk about how I approach problems, how I get better at them, and how I work in a team. I accept it when I fall short of understanding something, and I give my best to understand it from people better than me. I have a lot of respect for anyone I can learn from, and I am not ashamed to ask the same question twice if that is what it takes. It works the other way too. When someone is stuck on something I have already worked out, I will sit with them rather than hand over the answer, and I come out of those understanding it better than when I went in. Knowledge seems to be one of the few things that grows when you share it. I think about problems in systems, and I approach them that way. I think that is also what makes me useful explaining something to someone else - I still remember what it is like to not understand it yet.

I would encourage you to visit my portfolio at www.asmit.space.

I am a first-year M.S. Computer Science student at NYU Tandon, after a B.S. in Computer Science at Arizona State, and my classes this semester include algorithms and artificial intelligence. The research I can point to is a summer at the University of Delhi under Prof. R. P. Singh, optimizing Gaussian Process classifiers for high-dimensional data. The skills a lab could use, as a list: Python and SQL for data pipelines, React and React Native, LLM pipelines with Whisper and streaming responses, dashboards, Blender and Three.js. At the AI Society at Arizona State I wrote the materials for and ran the workshops that made machine learning approachable to students with no technical background, which is the closest thing I have done to explaining research to people outside it.

The subject I would most like to be matched on sits between computer science and philosophy. I mean how intelligence should progress hand in hand with people rather than past them, the cases where what is sold as AI is closer to a con than a tool, and who controls the data underneath. Both of the projects I care most about came out of those questions. Torii exists because I could not explain to myself who is accountable when an AI agent holding a wallet overspends. I built a proxy that sits between the agent and every paid tool it calls and writes down every blocked call with its reason. The human controls policy. The agent controls execution. Lead Engine calls homeowners with an AI voice and scouts public listings and county records at scale, which is where the question of who controls the data stops being abstract. I would take work on any side of this - philosophy of mind, the ethics of AI, data governance - with people who have thought about it longer than I have.

I can fit research hours around my classes, which are on Tuesday and Wednesday evenings and Friday late morning, with none on Monday or Thursday, and I can do more over the breaks. I am on an F-1 visa, which permits on-campus employment without further authorization. I would be glad to be passed along to any group that could use this.